

PII SENTINEL

Complete Non-Technical User Manual & Easy Installation Guide

NON-TECHNICAL MANUAL: This guide is designed for normal, non-technical users. It explains all features in clear, everyday language and walks you through the installation process from zero to fully running.

1. What is PII Sentinel in Simple Words?

Think of PII Sentinel like an **Antivirus program for your private data**. While standard antivirus tools search for malicious software, PII Sentinel searches for private personal data — like Aadhaar cards, PAN cards, credit cards, bank accounts, and passwords.

Two Jobs in One App:

1. **The Search Engine:** It scans your computer to find hidden sensitive files so you can organize or watermark them.
2. **The Active Shield:** When you work in Microsoft Word or Excel, it prevents you from accidentally saving confidential numbers.

PRIVACY PROMISE: 100% Offline: It never connects to the internet and never sends your files to external cloud servers. Everything stays on your laptop.

2. All Features Explained in Plain Language

Feature 1: The Smart File Scanner

- **Universal Reading:** Automatically inspects Word, Excel, PowerPoint, PDF, text, CSV, and image files.
- **Fast & Light:** Scans hundreds of files in seconds without slowing down your computer.

Feature 2: 36 Sensitive Data Detectors

- **IDs & Compliance:** Aadhaar numbers (with official checksum checks), PAN cards, Passports, and Voter IDs.
- **Personal & Financial:** Names, emails, home addresses, phone numbers, and credit card numbers.
- **IT Secrets:** Passwords, server keys, Amazon cloud credentials, and developer tokens.

Feature 3: The 5-Color Risk Rating (Traffic Light System)

- **■ Restricted (Top Secret):** Passwords, cloud keys, bulk Aadhaar cards.
- **■ Highly Confidential:** Salary sheets, customer financial records, PAN cards.
- **■ Confidential:** Internal contracts, internal memos, team communications.
- **■ General & ■ Public:** Normal business documents and shareable public materials.

Feature 4: Real-Time Microsoft Office Save Guard

- **In-Memory Save Guard:** Whenever you press Save (Ctrl + S) in Word or Excel, it checks the file in under 0.03 seconds.
- **The Block Warning:** If private data is detected, Word pauses and warns you before saving.
- **Legitimate Override:** If you have permission for your work, type a short reason and click Save Anyway.

Feature 5: The Background Shield & Safe Vault (Quarantine)

- **Continuous Protection:** Monitors Downloads, Desktop, and Documents for risky files from Chrome, Slack, etc.
- **Encrypted Vault:** Automatically locks risky files inside a password-encrypted ZIP archive.

Feature 6: Official Watermarking with Magic Undo

- **Branded Watermarks:** Stamps clean, official 'CONFIDENTIAL' banners on Word, Excel, PPT, and PDF files.
- **1-Click Undo:** An automatic backup is always made before watermarking. Click 'Undo' anytime to get your original back!

3. How to Install from Scratch (Zero-to-Ready Guide)

Option A: The 1-Click Installer (Recommended for Everyone)

- Step 1:** Locate the installer file **PIISentinel_Setup_v1.0.exe** (in the dist_installer folder).
- Step 2:** Double-click it. If Windows asks 'Do you want to allow this app to make changes?', click **Yes**.
- Step 3:** Click **Next**, keep the default install location, and ensure 'Create Desktop Shortcut' is checked.
- Step 4:** Click **Install** and then **Finish**. The app will launch immediately!
- Step 5:** Microsoft Word and Excel protection is activated automatically. No complex setup needed!

Option B: Running from Source Code (For Technical Users)

1. Install Python 3.10+ on Windows.
2. In the folder, run: `pip install -r requirements.txt`
3. Register Office Add-in: `powershell -File office_addin\build_and_register.ps1`
4. Start application: `python main.py`

4. Quick Start: Your First 5 Minutes

1. **Start Protection:** In the top bar, click 'Start Service' if it is offline.
2. **Run a Scan:** Go to 'Scan Directory', pick a folder, and click 'Start Inspection'.
3. **Review Results:** Check the color risk ratings in 'Results & Action'.
4. **Test Word Guard:** Open Word, type an Aadhaar or card number, and hit Ctrl+S to see the save guard in action!

5. Frequently Asked Questions

Q: Will it slow down my laptop?

A: No. It uses less than 30 milliseconds during Word saves and is completely dormant when idle.

Q: Do I need administrator rights to install it?

A: No. Both the app and Word add-in install into your user account without admin privileges.

Q: Does it work without an internet connection?

A: Yes. It is 100% offline and air-gapped.